

BABY SLEEP TRAINING GUIDE

Methods, Wake Windows, Nap Transitions & Schedules

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WAKE WINDOWS BY AGE

A wake window is how long baby can stay awake before needing sleep:

Newborn (0-4 wks): 45-60 minutes

1-2 months: 60-90 minutes

3-4 months: 75-120 minutes

5-7 months: 2-3 hours

8-10 months: 2.5-3.5 hours

11-14 months: 3-4 hours

15-18 months: 4-5.5 hours

2-3 years: 5-6 hours

TIP: Watch for sleepy cues - yawning, eye rubbing, fussiness

SLEEP TRAINING METHODS COMPARISON

1. FERBER METHOD (Graduated Extinction)

How it works: Put baby down awake, check at increasing intervals

Day 1: Check at 3, 5, 10, 10, 10 min...

Day 2: Check at 5, 10, 12, 12, 12 min...

Day 3: Check at 10, 12, 15, 15, 15 min...

During checks: Brief verbal comfort, no picking up. 30 seconds max.

Best for: 5+ months, parents who want structure, works in 3-7 days

2. GENTLE/CHAIR METHOD

How it works: Sit in chair next to crib, gradually move farther away

Days 1-3: Chair right next to crib, pat/shush

Days 4-6: Chair halfway across room

Days 7-9: Chair by the door

Days 10-12: Chair outside door (in hallway)

Best for: Anxious babies, parents who can't hear crying, takes 2-3 weeks

3. PICK UP/PUT DOWN

How it works: Pick up when crying, put down when calm. Repeat.

Best for: Under 6 months, parents who want very gentle approach

Takes longest: 2-4 weeks typically

BEDTIME ROUTINE (MUST BE CONSISTENT)

Same order, same time, every single night. 20-30 minutes total:

Time: ____:____ Start routine

☐ Bath (not necessary every night)

☐ Pajamas and diaper

☐ Feed (keep baby awake!)

☐ Book (1-2 short books)

☐ Song or white noise on

☐ Phrase: 'I love you. Time to sleep.'

☐ Place in crib DROWSY BUT AWAKE

Time: ____:____ Baby in crib

KEY: Baby must go INTO crib awake so they learn to fall asleep there!

NAP TRANSITIONS GUIDE

4 to 3 naps (around 4-5 months):

- Drop the late afternoon catnap
- Move bedtime earlier temporarily

3 to 2 naps (around 7-9 months):

- Drop the third nap when it interferes with bedtime
- Stretch wake windows gradually (15 min per day)

2 to 1 nap (around 13-18 months):

- THIS IS THE HARDEST TRANSITION
- Signs of readiness: fighting one nap consistently for 2+ weeks
- Move single nap to 12:00-12:30pm
- Early bedtime for 2-4 weeks during transition

1 to 0 naps (around 3-4 years):

- Replace nap with quiet time (books, puzzles in room)
- Move bedtime 30-60 min earlier

SLEEP LOG

Date: ____/____/____

Nap 1: ____:____ to ____:____ (length: ____ min)

Nap 2: ____:____ to ____:____ (length: ____ min)

Nap 3: ____:____ to ____:____ (length: ____ min)

Bedtime routine started: ____:____

In crib: ____:____ Fell asleep: ____:____

Night wakings: ____:____ | ____:____ | ____:____ | ____:____

Morning wake: ____:____

Total night sleep: ____ hrs Total day sleep: ____ hrs

Notes: _____

TROUBLESHOOTING SLEEP ISSUES

Taking 30+ min to fall asleep:

- Bedtime may be too early - push later by 15 min
- Not enough physical activity during the day

Waking at 5am:

- Room may not be dark enough (blackout curtains!)
- Last nap may be too late or too long
- Bedtime may be too late (overtired = early waking)

Waking every 1-2 hours:

- May need to learn independent sleep skills
- Check: hungry? teething? sick? too hot/cold?

Fighting naps:

- Wake window may be too short or too long
- Try a mini-routine before nap (book + song)
- Nap environment: dark, cool, white noise

By Daniel Tesfamariam | Good sleep is a skill. You can teach it with love.